

EXPERIMENT 3

Survey Report: Emerging Trends in Low-Code Application Development

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Aim

To study a survey of enterprise technology leaders on low-code development and summarise the market growth, architecture, user groups, AI features, industry adoption, governance needs and cost savings that it reports.

1. About the Survey

The source is an enterprise research survey published in July 2026. It gathered answers and interviews from 1,450 IT leaders and business executives in North America, Europe and Asia-Pacific, all from companies with more than 1,000 employees. Respondents were 42% CIOs/CTOs, 33% enterprise architects and 25% business and fusion-team leaders.

Headline figure	Value	What it means
Market size (2026)	\$65.0 billion	Low-code is now a mainstream software market
Enterprise penetration	77%	Most large firms already use it
New apps built with low-code	75%	Three in four new apps skip hand-coding
Average delivery cycle	3.2 weeks	Against 14.8 weeks for traditional builds
Generative-AI adoption	72%	AI is now part of most deployments
Users outside central IT	up to 80%	Business staff build many of the apps

2. Market Growth

The market grew from \$22.5 billion in 2022 to \$65.0 billion in 2026, a compound growth of over 26% a year, and is forecast to pass \$145 billion by 2030. The survey names three reasons for this rise: a shortage of professional developers (demand for digital products is estimated at five times what engineering teams can deliver), shorter application backlogs (over 90% of IT departments report fewer than five persistent backlogs after adopting low-code), and pressure to ship faster (3.2 weeks against 14.8).

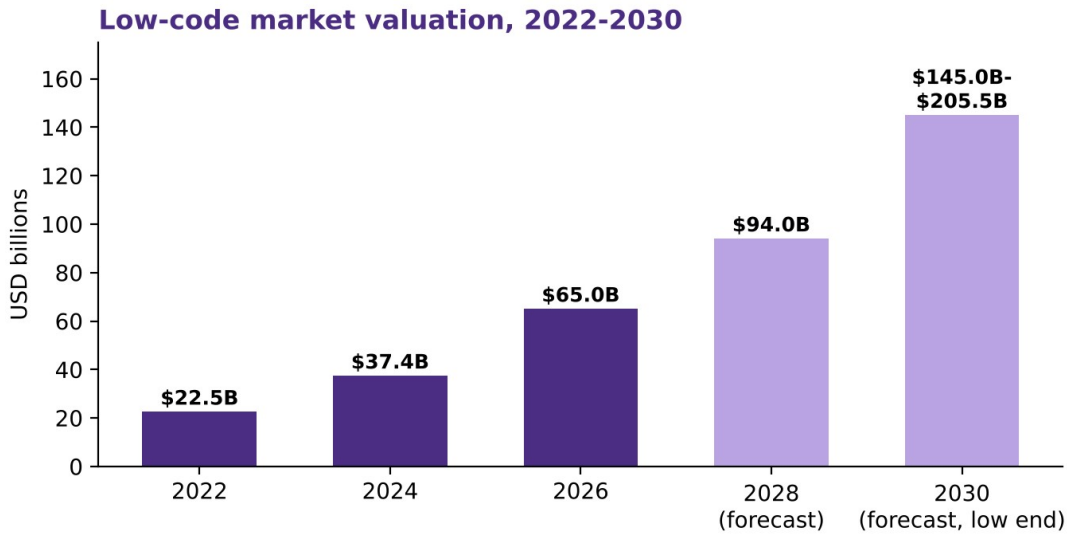


Fig 1: Market valuation by year (data from the survey)

Year	Value (USD)	Yearly growth	Main driver
2022	\$22.5 B	21.2%	Workflow automation and forms
2024	\$37.4 B	24.8%	Mobile apps and cloud move
2026	\$65.0 B	26.4%	Generative AI and fusion teams
2028 (forecast)	\$94.0 B	23.1%	Autonomous, agent-driven workflows
2030 (forecast)	\$145.0-205.5 B	20.5%	Low-code as the core of enterprise systems

3. Technology and Architecture

Early low-code tools were simple visual script builders. Modern platforms are cloud-native and are described in the survey as three stacked layers:

Layer	Contents
Presentation and UX	Drag-and-drop canvas; one app delivered to web, mobile PWA and desktop
Intelligence and automation	Natural-language prompting with generative AI; process mining and business-logic orchestration
Integration and data	Ready-made connectors to ERP, CRM and databases; role-based access, data-loss prevention and automated CI/CD pipelines

Three architectural shifts stand out. Platforms increasingly let teams export standard code (React, Java, .NET, Node.js), which eases the fear of vendor lock-in. Apps run as containers that scale across Kubernetes. And REST and GraphQL connectors let companies link old systems such as SAP, Oracle and mainframes without replacing them.

4. Citizen Developers and Fusion Teams

A fusion team pairs business experts with professional developers. Up to 80% of active platform users sit outside central IT, and fusion teams deploy 4.2 times faster. In a mature setup, business users configure screens and workflow rules, while engineers build the API wrappers, security layers and data validation.

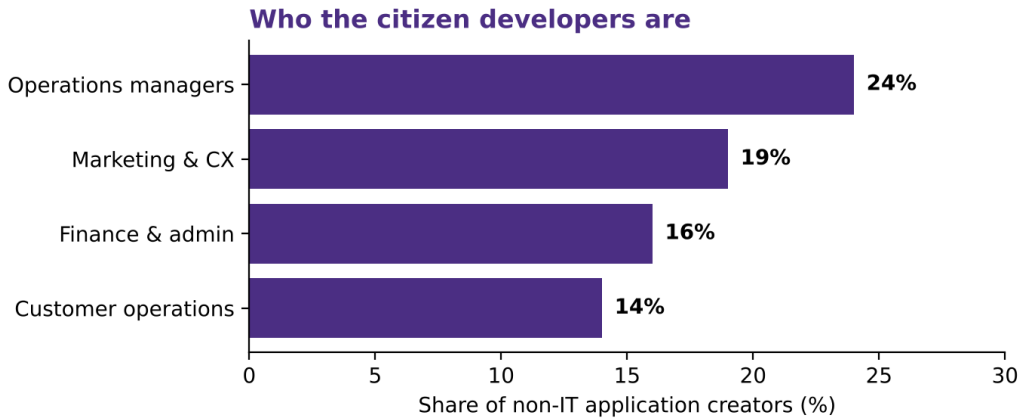


Fig 2: Departments creating the most apps outside IT

- **Operations managers:** supply-chain tracking, asset management and logistics workflows.
- **Marketing and customer experience:** customer portals, landing pages and campaign tracking.
- **Finance and administration:** invoice approval flows, compliance boards and expense tracking.
- **Customer operations:** ticketing systems, dispute handling and service bots.

5. Artificial Intelligence in Low-Code

Generative AI is the biggest recent change. The most common feature is prompt-to-app synthesis, where a plain-language description produces the database, screens and logic. Teams using AI-assisted platforms report 31.8% shorter pull-request review cycles and 45% fewer bugs before release.

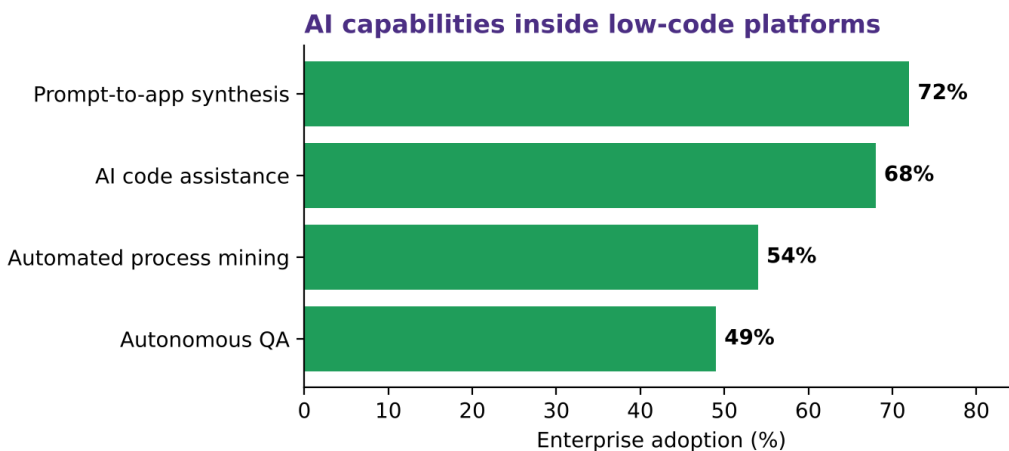


Fig 3: Adoption of AI capabilities

6. Adoption by Industry

Regulated industries lead because they need repeatable, auditable processes. Banking and financial services are highest at 82%, and the public sector is lowest at 54%.

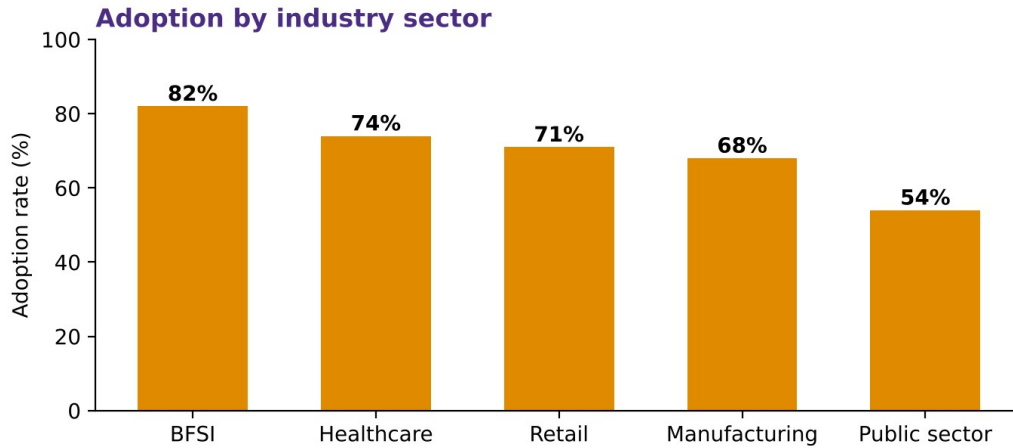


Fig 4: Enterprise adoption rate by sector

- **BFSI:** fast customer onboarding, loan processing and compliance reporting portals.
- **Healthcare:** patient portals, appointment scheduling and HIPAA-compliant intake forms.
- **Manufacturing:** shop-floor inspection apps, inventory dashboards and supply-chain tracking.

7. Governance, Security and Risk

When non-IT staff build apps, unmanaged "shadow IT" becomes a danger: 61% of IT leaders rank it among their top security and compliance weaknesses. The survey grades organisations on a four-level maturity scale.

Level	How it is run	Security controls
1 Unmanaged	Departments build on their own with no central view	None; high risk of leaks and violations
2 Managed	Central licensing and basic role-based access	Approved API connections; manual IT approval
3 CoE framework	Formal Center of Excellence and structured fusion teams	Automated code scanning; enforced sandboxes
4 Optimised	Continuous compliance audits, data lineage, auto-retirement of apps	Real-time data-loss prevention, zero trust, full logging

8. Cost, Speed and Return on Investment

Every application type in the survey was cheaper and quicker to build with low-code, with savings between 69% and 79%.

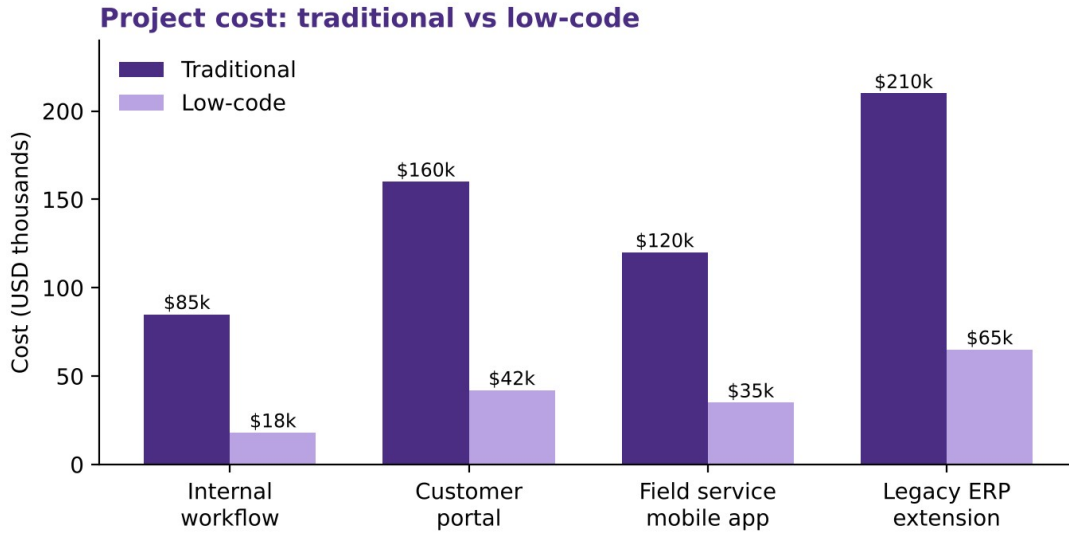


Fig 5: Traditional vs low-code project cost

Application type	Cost saved	Traditional time	Low-code time
Internal workflow automation	78.8%	12 weeks	2 weeks
Customer-facing portal	73.7%	20 weeks	4 weeks
Field service mobile app	70.8%	16 weeks	3.5 weeks
Legacy ERP extension	69.0%	24 weeks	6 weeks

Deployments break even in about 5.4 months on average, and maintenance effort falls by 48% because the platform maintains its own components.

9. Recommendations

- Set up a Center of Excellence first, to fix standards and data-access rules before wider rollout.
- Build fusion teams that pair developers with department experts.
- Limit the tools to two or three enterprise-grade platforms that support open standards and APIs, to avoid sprawl.
- Build data-loss prevention, role-based access and code scanning into the deployment pipeline.

10. Link to Zoho Creator (Experiment 2)

The survey describes the same ideas that were seen in Zoho Creator: Environments (Stage and Production) match the automated deployment pipelines, Users and Governance match role-based access and security policy, and Portal and Mobile match multi-experience delivery for customers and staff.

Result

The survey was studied and summarised. It shows a fast-growing market, wide use by business staff, rising AI features, and large cost and time savings, provided that governance is put in place early.

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